NORTHSTAR
DIGITAL SERVICES

Code of Conduct

EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

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Prepared as synthetic content for a role-based retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) demonstration. This document is not an actual company policy.

Access classification: EMPLOYEE • MANAGER • HR

1. Values and expected behaviour

Policy owner: HR

Purpose

The Code of Conduct describes minimum behaviour standards for people working with Northstar Digital Services, a fictional organization. It applies during work, business travel, company events and professional interactions where a person represents the company.

Respect and inclusion

Treat colleagues, customers, candidates, vendors and visitors with dignity. Harassment, bullying, discrimination, threats and retaliation are not acceptable. Differences of opinion should be handled professionally and without personal attacks.

Integrity

Be honest in business records, expense claims, time reporting, customer communications and technical work. Do not falsify results, conceal material errors or misrepresent qualifications, approvals or project status.

Conflicts of interest

Disclose personal, financial or family interests that could improperly influence company decisions. Examples include selecting a vendor owned by a close relative or participating in a hiring decision involving a close friend.

Gifts and hospitality

Accept or offer gifts only within approved limits and where doing so cannot reasonably influence a business decision. Cash or cash-equivalent gifts are prohibited under this sample policy. Seek guidance before accepting unusual hospitality.

Use of authority

Company authority, access and resources must be used for legitimate business purposes. Never pressure another person to provide personal benefits or bypass a required control.

2. Information, assets and business decisions

Policy owner: HR

Confidential information

Protect customer data, source code, financial information, employee records, credentials and internal plans. Share information only with people who need it for an authorized purpose.

Privacy and data minimization

Collect and use personal information only for legitimate work purposes, limit access, and follow retention and deletion rules. Do not search records out of curiosity or share screenshots containing personal information without authorization.

Company property

Use devices, software, facilities, accounts and funds responsibly. Do not use company assets for illegal activity, unauthorized commercial work or activity that creates avoidable security risk.

Accurate records

Business records should be complete, traceable and retained under the applicable schedule. Never backdate approvals, delete records to hide misconduct or ask another person to record something inaccurately.

Fair dealing

Make purchasing, hiring and customer decisions using relevant criteria. Do not offer bribes, collude with competitors, misuse inside information or obtain confidential information through deception.

AI and automation

Use only approved AI tools for company work. Do not submit restricted information to public services without authorization, and verify generated output before relying on it for consequential decisions.

Social media

Do not disclose confidential information or imply that personal opinions are official company statements. Refer media inquiries to the designated communications contact.

3. Speaking up and accountability

Policy owner: HR

Raise concerns

Report suspected misconduct, safety risks, fraud, security incidents or policy breaches through a manager, HR, Security, Compliance or the designated reporting channel. If the concern involves the manager, use another channel.

Non-retaliation

Good-faith reporting and participation in an investigation must not result in retaliation. Deliberately fabricated allegations may be addressed, but an unsubstantiated concern is not by itself proof of bad faith.

Cooperation

Employees should preserve relevant records, answer questions honestly and avoid discussing sensitive investigation details with people who do not need to know.

Consequences

Depending on facts, severity and applicable law, a breach may result in coaching, training, access restrictions, formal discipline or termination. Outcomes should be proportionate and consistently applied.

Manager duties

Managers should model the code, address concerns promptly, avoid promising absolute secrecy and escalate matters they cannot fairly investigate themselves.

FAQ: What if a colleague asks me to share a password?

Do not share credentials. Direct the colleague to the approved access-request process and report suspicious requests.

FAQ: Can I report anonymously?

Use the anonymous option if the company reporting channel supports it. Provide enough factual detail for review and avoid speculation.

Review and ownership

HR and Compliance jointly maintain the code. Employees are expected to read updates and complete required training. Local laws and approved contractual terms take precedence where they provide greater protection.